



DEFENSE ADVANCED RESEARCH PROJECTS AGENCY
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DETERMINATIONS AND FINDINGS
CONSOLIDATION OF CONTRACT REQUIREMENTS
FOR
Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA)
Biological Technologies Office (BTO)
Operational and Program Support Services

As defined in Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 2.101 consolidation means “a solicitation for a single contract, a multiple-award contract, a task order, or a delivery order to satisfy two or more requirements of the Federal agency for supplies or services that have been provided to or performed for the Federal agency under two or more separate contracts, each of which was lower in cost than the total cost of the contract for which offers are solicited.” Consolidation of requirements with a total value exceeding \$2 million must be justified.

I have reviewed this requirement and associated market research and determined that consolidation, in accordance with FAR 7.107 *‘Additional requirements for acquisitions involving consolidation, bundling, or substantial bundling’*, is both necessary and justified. The review resulted in the following findings:

FINDINGS

A. Background

The purpose of this procurement is to provide support services to BTO in the following areas: technical, programmatic, independent assessments and analyses, outreach, administrative, documentation, briefing, graphics, website, event assistance, financial/ program control, acquisition, concept development, technical expertise, background research and bibliographic research risk assessment, small business innovation research (SBIR) management, small business technology transfer (SBTT) testing/ demonstrations/ transition.

The requested services are considered non-commercial in nature, and a single hybrid task order with Cost-Plus-Fixed-Fee (CPFF), Cost-Reimbursable (No-Fee), and Award-Fee CLINs is anticipated with a period of performance (PoP) of one 6-month base period, four 12-month option years, and a 6-month final period. The Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE) is [REDACTED] under proposed solicitation number HR001126RE003.

Redefining of the Requirement: This consolidation of three task orders is a direct result of eliminating the current overlapping scope of work/tasks being performed. All three task orders encompass Operational Support Services (front office administrative, business financial management, and subject matter experts (SMEs) support) and Program Support Services (support of new and ongoing biotechnology programs to include contributions at reviews, site visits, demonstrations, and other events). This acquisition approach provides separate distinct



work that ultimately eliminates the need for three separate task orders by redefining the scope of work and removing redundancy of work as well as generating better measures of control in terms of cost.

The three task order awards to be consolidated into one distinct requirement are:

- HR001118D0007/HR001121F0031 (aka BTO1),
- HR001118D0006/HR001121F0024 (aka BTO2),
- HR001118D0001/HR001121F0036 (aka BTO3).

All three task orders were competed using the Technical and Analytical Support Services (TASS) Multiple-Award Indefinite Delivery Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) contracts.

BTO1 was awarded to [REDACTED], other than small business, on August 6, 2021, with a PoP of August 16, 2021 – August 15, 2026.

BTO2 was awarded to [REDACTED], other than small business, on July 14, 2021, with a PoP is July 31, 2021 – July 30, 2026.

BTO3 was awarded to [REDACTED], other than small business, on August 30, 2021, with a PoP is August 31, 2021 – August 30, 2026.

B. Selection of Acquisition Strategy

Consistent with FAR 7.107-1, the acquisition team performed the following steps and analyses in selecting the recommended acquisition strategy:

1. Market research:

As market research identified GSA OASIS+ as an appropriate OMB government-wide best-in-class contract for these Advisory & Assistance Services, the use of this contract vehicle is appropriate and satisfies the requirements of DARPA Instruction 28 (Acquisition of Services). This BTO support services requirement is considered non-commercial due to the unique and unpredictable nature of Department of War priorities, particularly in view of DARPA's mission focus on advanced research and development (i.e., focus on technologies not yet in existence) and security clearance requirements. In accordance with the market research, a small business set-aside is not required or advisable. See the Market Research Report for additional information.

2. Alternative contracting approach that would involve a lesser degree of consolidation:

DARPA could maintain the status quo by keeping the existing requirements separate and intact "as-is".

3. Coordination with the agency's Office of Small Business Programs:

This determination is coordinated with DARPA's Small Business Programs Office (SBPO) through approval of this document and using the DD Form 2579 Small Business Coordination Record.

4. Negative impact of the acquisition strategy on contracting with small business concerns:

There is no negative impact to small business due to this acquisition strategy. These services are currently awarded task orders under the Technical and Analytical Support Services (TASS) IDIQ and are not being performed by small businesses.

5. Steps taken to include small business concerns in the acquisition strategy:

OASIS+ Unrestricted IDIQ contracts have Small Business Subcontracting Plans and small business subcontracting goals (SB 50%; SDB 7%, WOSB 7%, HUBZone 3%, VOSB 3%, SDVOSB 3%) incorporated at the master contract level, which will encourage small business participation to the maximum extent practicable.

C. Benefits of Consolidation

1. Cost savings or price reductions:

A cost savings analysis was performed by comparing the estimated cost of awarding three separate task orders to awarding a single task order.

The total full-time equivalents (FTEs) for the three task orders totaled [REDACTED], whereas the total FTEs for a consolidated task order was [REDACTED]. This difference was [REDACTED] FTEs which were the Contractor Task Order Program Manager (CTOPM) FTEs. Each task order would require [REDACTED] CTOPM FTEs totaling [REDACTED] FTEs. The single task order would require [REDACTED] CTOPM FTEs. The total estimated cost for the [REDACTED] CTOPM FTEs for the three task orders over a 5-year period of performance would be [REDACTED]. The single task order total estimated cost for [REDACTED] CTOPM FTEs over a 5-year period is [REDACTED]. Eliminating the [REDACTED] CTOPM FTEs, by consolidating the three task orders into one task order, results in an estimated cost savings of [REDACTED].

The Government can expect additional cost savings by combining requirements and competitively awarding only one task order [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] This reduction in labor cost is realized from further efficiencies and oversight of the requirement beyond the reduced direct CTOPM costs, and economies of scale savings from competitive

discounts will be provided based on the expected amount of increased potential future work. These expected benefits through competition anticipate a total labor reduction of [REDACTED]. Further cost savings will be achieved through the consolidation of these three task orders by decreasing the administrative burden for the Government and acquisition support contractors in both the pre-award and post-award phases. If these requirements were not consolidated, three separate contracts would have to be awarded and administered. The increased amount of time that the Contracting Officer(s), Contract Specialist(s), Contracting Officer's Representative(s) (COR), and technical evaluation boards would have to devote over this period of time to award three separate task orders would be more time intensive.

If they were awarded separately, up to three Contract Specialists could be required to support the contracts. In pre-award, this would conservatively amount to [REDACTED] hours of increased support at a labor rate of [REDACTED]/hour, equating to approximately [REDACTED] for the pre-award work on the additional contracts. In post-award administration with various modifications and other tasks, this would be approximately [REDACTED] additional hours per year, equaling to about [REDACTED]. For a Contracting Officer (as a [REDACTED]) spending the same number of hours as a Contract Specialist, but on different tasks, this would be about [REDACTED] in pre-award and around [REDACTED] in post-award. Cost savings would be achieved for the COR (as a [REDACTED] level employee) at about [REDACTED]. Cost savings are estimated for one task order for the Contract Specialist, Contracting Officer, and COR. For technical evaluation boards [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]. This adds up to nearly [REDACTED] total cost savings for reduction of administrative burden.

The total quantifiable benefits equal [REDACTED].

2. *Quality improvements that will save time or enhance performance or efficiency:*

- a. There will be one contractor project manager (with part-time support from three subject area leads) overseeing all the BTO SETA requirements for the task order, so there is more potential for that individual to find efficiencies and use for total solutions within the full scope of BTO support services.
- b. Improvements in the quality of deliverables will be realized with one contractor project

- manager providing unified oversight and vision of the related efforts within the single, distinct requirement.
- c. One contractor, having the ability to review personnel shortfalls and necessary skills across the entire requirement will result in potential improvements in recruitment of qualified personnel and a more balanced workforce.
 - d. Government oversight of a single task order will encourage open and more consistent communication with the contractor.
 - e. One task order will increase contractor accountability and efficiency with a clearly delineated division of BTO requirements handled by one contractor rather than confusion over whether certain office needs may be handled by a different contractor with related scope.
 - f. One task order will improve contractor team cohesion and collaboration, resulting in enhanced performance, as it should remove any underlying perception of competition among contractor-support personnel.

3. *Reduction in acquisition cycle times:*

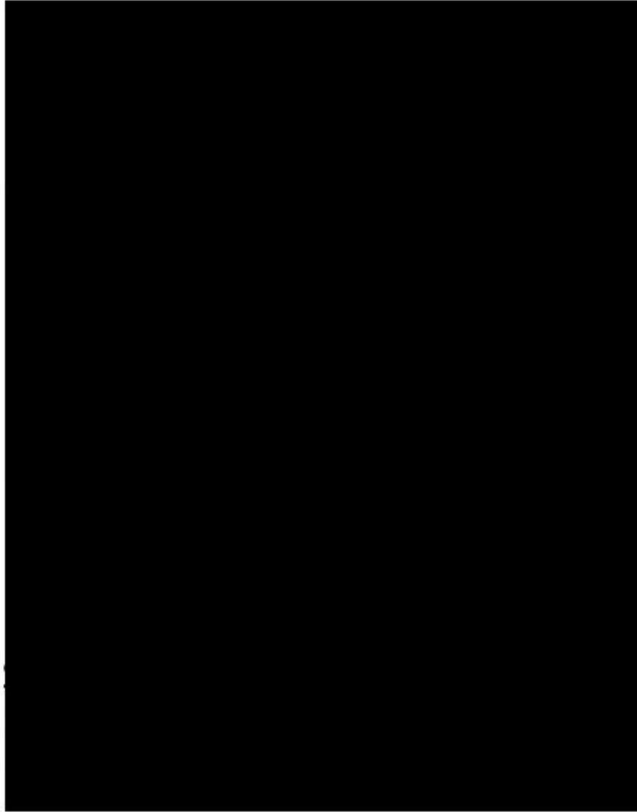
The acquisition cycle time for the planned consolidated task order will be shorter by [REDACTED] compared to acquiring the requirements under three task orders separately, assuming concurrent contracting and requirements owner personnel bandwidth would otherwise even accommodate supporting three source selections at once. The pre-award development of the requirement has been and will be efficiently consolidated into one task order file rather than having to create separate pre-award documentation for three separate requirements.

DETERMINATION

Based on the above facts, I determine that in accordance with FAR 7.107-2:

1. The necessary steps have been taken to support the need for consolidation.
2. The benefits of the acquisition substantially exceed the benefits that would be derived from the alternative contracting approach identified under paragraph B.2 above, including benefits that are quantifiable in dollar amounts as well as the other specifically identified benefits above.
3. As a result, consolidation of the above-mentioned requirement is necessary and justified.

Coordination Concurrence /Approval



Director, Senior Procurement Executive, CMO

Coordinated with:



Small Business Programs Office Representative